

Week 8 — Diagnosis by Hearing & Smelling

EAM310 · EAST ASIAN MEDICINE DIAGNOSIS I · VUIM SUMMER 2026

⚠ Quiz 6 — September 4, 2026

Class: Friday September 4, 2026 · 9AM–1PM

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REQUIRED READINGS — DUE BEFORE SEPTEMBER 4

FCM CHAPTER 26 — MACIOCIA

- Diagnosis by Hearing & Smelling — full chapter
- Voice, breathing, cough, vomiting, hiccup
- Borborygmi, sighing, belching
- Body odour & odour of bodily secretions
- Five-Element voice/smell correspondences

CAM CHAPTER 9 — CHENG XINNONG

- Auscultation & Olfaction (聞診) — one combined pillar
- The character 聞 wén means both "hear" and "smell"
- General rules: loud=Full, weak=Empty; foul=Heat, absent=Cold
- Integration with Observation, Inquiry, Palpation

WEEK 8 LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Explain the Voice-Zang Fu relationship (Lung/Kidney/Spleen-Stomach roles)
- Differentiate abnormal vocalizations (hoarseness types)
- Interpret vomiting, hiccup, belching as Rebellious Stomach-Qi
- Match Five-Element body odours to their organ correspondences
- Identify the Five-Element sounds and their organ correspondences
- Interpret breathing, panting, cough, and respiratory sound patterns
- Apply the general smelling rule: foul=Heat, absent=Cold
- Interpret odours of breath, sweat, sputum, urine, stool, and secretions

ASSESSMENT CALENDAR

Date	Event	Material Covered
Aug 28	Week 7 Class	Diagnosis by Inquiry & Palpation
Sep 4	⚠ Quiz 6	Diagnosis by Hearing & Smelling — voice, sounds, odours
Sep 11	FINAL + Journal 26–50	Weeks 6–9 comprehensive

IN-CLASS PRACTICE — WHAT TO EXPECT

LISTENING & SMELLING PRACTICE LAB

Week 8 includes partner listening/observation practice. Come ready to:

- Listen to a partner's natural speaking voice — assess volume, pitch, willingness to talk
- Identify which Five-Element sound quality best matches their baseline voice
- Practice distinguishing productive vs unproductive cough sounds (recordings/demo)
- Document Four-Pillar findings (Observation + Inquiry + Palpation + Hearing/Smelling) together in your Journal

HEARING & SMELLING 聞 WÉN — ONE COMBINED PILLAR

The same Chinese character 聞 **wén** means both "to hear" AND "to smell" — this is why Auscultation and Olfaction form ONE combined diagnostic pillar, not two separate ones. **General rule (hearing):** loud sound = Full pattern, weak sound = Empty pattern. **General rule (smelling):** strong/foul smell = Heat, absence of smell = Cold.

VOICE & ZANG-FU ORGAN RELATIONSHIP

Organ	Role in Voice Production
Lung	The gateway of the voice — the movement of Qi helps create sounds. Production of sound is directly related to this organ.
Kidney	The root of the voice. Root of Yuan Qi, controls reception of Qi. The volume of the voice is directly related to this organ.
Spleen & Stomach	Acquired root of Qi. Influences vocalization. The strength of the voice is directly related to these organs.

Clinical shortcut: Production = Lung · Volume = Kidney · Strength = Spleen/Stomach. A voice problem localizes to a different organ depending on WHICH quality is off.

VOICE — GENERAL PATTERNS

Loud voice	Full or Heat pattern
Weak voice	Empty or Cold pattern
Weak and vague voice	Exterior Wind-Cold, or Dampness
Reluctance to talk	Cold pattern or Lung-Qi deficiency
Excessive talking	Heat pattern
Sudden loss of voice	Invasion of exterior Wind-Heat
Gradual loss of voice	Lung-Qi or Lung-Yin deficiency

FIVE-ELEMENT SOUNDS — WITH CHINESE TERMS

Element / Organ	Sound	Clinical Character
Wood / Liver	Shouting <i>hū</i> 呼	Forcefulness to the voice; indication of assertion. Wanting to be heard, explicitly or implicitly asking for change. Frequently becomes louder at moments the person doesn't need to be particularly assertive.
Fire / Heart	Laughing <i>xiào</i> 笑	Occurs expressing joy — doesn't necessarily mean an actual belly laugh (can be a "pre-laugh" quality). Fire is very Yang; laughter rises upwards/outwards like the sound itself.
Earth / Spleen	Singing <i>chàng</i> 唱	May occur naturally when soothing a child or distressed person/animal. Increased variation in pitch — voice goes up and down more frequently.
Metal / Lung	Weeping	Consumes or dissolves Qi. More non-verbal, expressive-emotional quality. When speaking with a weep, may easily begin to cry, or show a choking-back/faltering in words.
Water / Kidney	Groaning	Little movement or modulation in quality. Flatness — as if the normal ups and downs of the voice have been squeezed or flattened out.

ABNORMAL VOCALIZATIONS — HOARSENESS

Presentation	Pattern
Sudden onset, voice low in pitch and raspy	Exterior syndrome
Chronic with gradual intensity	Blood stagnation
Hoarseness with plum-pit sensation & cough	Phlegm-Heat
Chronic onset, gradually increasing intensity, worse in evening	Lung and Kidney-Yin deficiency

BREATHING — GENERAL PATTERNS

Coarse, loud breathing	Full pattern
Weak, thin breathing	Empty pattern
Deep breathing	Excess Qi in the Heart and Lungs
Weak breathing	Deficiency of Qi in Liver and Kidney
Rough respiration, rapid inhalation & slow exhalation	Heat, Excess, exogenous condition
Faint respiration, slow inhalation & exhalation	Deficiency condition or chronic internal condition

RESPIRATION — EXCESS/HEAT VS EMPTY/COLD

Type	Presentation
Excess and/or Heat	Sound of respiration is loud, breath rough and distressed, acute onset. Seen in surplus of external contraction of evil or Phlegm-Heat invading the Lung.
Empty and/or Cold	Sound of respiration is low, breath faint and slow, relatively slow onset of disease. Seen in internal damage causing insufficient Zheng Qi and Kidney/Lung-Qi vacuity.

PANTING — EXCESS VS DEFICIENCY

Panting: rapid, irregular respiration, extreme to the point nostrils move, uneven entrance/exit of breath, mouth opens, shoulders raise, difficulty lying down.	
Excess	Respiration irregular, chest full, sound loud, breath rough, exit irregular and exhalation uneven — disease/Xie Qi obstructing the Lung
Deficiency	Respiration irregular, breath timid, voice low, inhalation diminished and exhalation increased, rapid inhalation, panting more severe with movement — Kidney deficiency (can't absorb Qi) or Lung deficiency (can't govern Qi)

ABNORMAL RESPIRATION — BY SPECIFIC PRESENTATION

Asthma	Lung-Qi's failure to descend
Wheezing	Lung-Qi fails to descend with Phlegm obstruction
Upper Stifling	Lung-Qi rises upward to throat and obstructs air tract
Shortness of Breath	Lung-Qi deficiency or Water Retention in chest (coughing watery sputum)
Shortage of Qi	Lung-Qi obstructed, Lung-Qi deficiency, Zheng Qi insufficient

COUGH 咳嗽 KÉ SÒU

Due to the Lung not diffusing & downbearing, Lung-Qi rising counterflow, and Phlegm/Qi flooding the airways.	
Loud, explosive cough	Full pattern
Weak cough	Empty pattern
Dry cough	Lung-Yin deficiency
Sound without phlegm	"Unproductive cough"
Phlegm with sound	"Productive cough"

SNEEZING & YAWNING

Sneezing	Pattern
Acute onset, constant loud sounds	Heat and/or Excess condition
Chronic, frequent, soft in volume	Lung-Qi deficiency
Sudden sneezing in critical stage of chronic illness	Yang-Qi recovery
Sneezing due to external stimulation	Normal

Yawning	Pattern
Frequent, loud, relieved after yawn, induced by emotional changes	Liver-Qi stagnation
Accompanied by chest pain, after injury or chronic illness	Blood and Qi stagnation
Infrequent, weak or no sound	Spleen/Kidney-Yang deficiency

VOMITING, BELCHING & HICCUP — ALL REBELLIOUS STOMACH-QI		
Symptom	Mechanism	Differences
Vomiting	Rebellious Stomach-Qi	Food, fluid, or sputum flows up from the Stomach and out of the mouth with sound
Belching		Air or gas flows up from the Stomach and makes sound passing through the throat
Hiccup		Stomach-Qi's rebellion causes involuntary spasms of the diaphragm, making a short sound

VOMITING — FULL VS EMPTY	
Deficiency and/or Cold pattern	Comes slowly; sound of retching relatively low, faint, without force. Frequently Stomach deficiency and Cold.
Excess and/or Heat pattern	Comes relatively suddenly; sound of retching relatively loud and forceful. Frequently Stomach-Heat.

HICCUP & BELCHING	
Hiccup, loud sound	Full pattern — often Liver-Qi invading the Stomach
Hiccup, quiet/low sound	Empty pattern — often Stomach-Qi or Stomach-Yin deficiency
Belching, loud and long	Full condition — retention of food, Stomach-Heat, or Liver-Qi invading Stomach
Belching, short and low	Deficient condition — Stomach-Qi deficiency, or Stomach-Qi deficiency with Cold

BORBORYGMI 腸鳴	
Loud sound	Full pattern (usually with diarrhoea or dysentery) — Cold-Damp in MB, Phlegm-Damp in MB, LV/SP disharmony, or Damp-Heat in ST & Intestines
Low sound	Empty pattern — SP/KD-Yang deficiency, or Middle Burner Qi deficiency

SIGHING	
	Generally indicates Qi stagnation of the Liver or Lungs — often from emotional problems: repressed anger/frustration (Liver) or worry/sadness (Lungs). A weak sighing sound may indicate deficiency of Spleen and Heart deriving from sadness, grief, or pensiveness.

A classical Qigong practice using specific exhaled sounds paired with breath and posture to regulate each organ's Qi — the therapeutic INVERSE of using sound diagnostically. Each sound targets a specific organ system.

THE SIX HEALING SOUNDS — FULL REFERENCE

Sound	Organ	Therapeutic Function
Xū 嘘	Liver	Removes Heat, disperses blockages, brings brightness to the eyes
Hē 呵	Heart	Expels Heat, makes Qi descend, reduces Fire in the Heart
Hū 呼	Spleen	Drives out Heat, strengthens the Spleen in all four seasons
Sì 呬	Lung	Moderates stress, calms the Qi, moistens the Lungs
Chuī 吹	Kidney	Removes Wind and Cold, urges stagnant Qi, brings tranquility to the Kidneys
Xī 嘻	Triple Burner	Clears Heat and restlessness, drives out strong emotional afflictions

Clinical note: This is DISTINCT from the Five-Element diagnostic sounds (Shouting/Laughing/Singing/Weeping/Groaning) on the prior page — those are pathological signs read FROM the patient; the Six Healing Sounds are prescribed treatments GIVEN to the patient.

DIAGNOSIS BY HEARING — FULL SUMMARY TABLE

Sound Category	Quick Rule
Voice	Loud = Full/Heat · Weak = Empty/Cold
Breathing	Coarse/loud = Full · Weak/thin = Empty
Cough	Loud/explosive = Full · Weak = Empty · Dry = LU-Yin def
Vomiting	Loud = Full/Heat (ST-Heat) · Low = Empty/Cold (ST def+Cold)
Hiccup	Loud = Full (LV-Qi invading ST) · Quiet = Empty (ST-Qi/Yin def)
Borborygmi	Loud = Full (usu. w/ diarrhoea) · Low = Empty
Sighing	LV/LU Qi stagnation (anger/frustration or worry/sadness)
Belching	Loud/long = Full (food retention, ST-Heat, LV-Qi invading ST) · Short/low = Deficient (ST-Qi def)

TWO ASPECTS OF DIAGNOSIS BY SMELLING

① Body Odour	Gives an idea of the prevailing pattern of disharmony AND the patient's constitutional Element type
② Bodily Secretions	Used only to identify the prevailing pattern of disharmony (not constitutional)

General rule: Any strong, foul smell is indicative of Heat. Absence of smell is indicative of Cold. Diagnosis by smelling is not a major/clinching part of the process — mostly used to CONFIRM a pattern already suspected from other pillars.

FIVE-ELEMENT BODY ODOURS

Element / Organ	Odour	Sensory Description
Wood / Liver	Rancid sōu 餿	Fat that's no longer fresh, or slightly sour. Also related to newly-mown grass smell but not pleasant. Prickling effect inside the nose.
Fire / Heart	Scorched xiào 笑	Burnt toast, clothes from a tumble dryer, a shirt just scorched while ironing
Earth / Spleen	Fragrant xiāng 香	Despite the name — NOT a pleasant floral smell. More cloying, sickly sweet, tends to linger in the nostrils
Metal / Lung	Rotten làn 爛	Fills the nose with tiny prickles, may cause nose-clenching. Rotting meat is the best verbal description — or a trash truck where many substances decompose
Water / Kidney	Putrid fǔ 腐	Rotting meat; smell of stagnant pond water or stale urine. Sharp, aggressive — makes the nose clench

Constitutional vs pathological mismatch: A Wood-type person's baseline odour is naturally slightly rancid — that alone isn't pathological. But if a Wood-type person's odour becomes SCORCHED (Fire's odour) instead, this indicates a Heart pattern is now present. A mismatched odour (wrong Element) is actually a WORSE sign than an exaggerated version of one's own constitutional odour.

OTHER BODY ODOUR PRESENTATIONS

Goatish odour	Wind, Damp, Heat accumulation
Foul, stinking	Epidemic infectious disease, or Summer-Heat toxin
Foul, set in the armpit	Damp-Heat accumulation
Strong, offensive general odour	Damp-Heat

BREATH	
Strong, foul	Stomach-Heat or retention of food
Sour	Retention of food; Accumulation Disorder (in children)
Foul, pungent	Damp-Heat in Stomach and Spleen
Rotten	Damp-Heat in Large Intestine (may relate to ulcerative colitis)
Fishy	Phlegm-Heat in Lung
SWEAT	
Related to Dampness — sweat's fluids come from the space between skin and muscles, where Dampness often accumulates.	
Strong-smelling	Damp-Heat
Putrid-smelling	Disease of the Lungs, Liver, or Kidneys
SPUTUM	
Strong, often rotten	Heat in the Lungs — usually Phlegm-Heat or Toxic Heat
Fishy-smelling	Lung-Heat
Without smell	Cold
STOOL & FLATULENCE	
Extremely stinky, foul, diarrhoea w/ pus or blood, flatulence	Damp-Heat in the Intestines
Sour and foul odour with indigestion	Food stagnation
Fishy odour with loose stools	Cold in Spleen/Stomach
Slight/odourless flatulence, aggravated by emotional stress	Liver-Qi stagnation
Flatulence smells rancid and rotten (like rotten eggs)	Toxic Heat in the Large Intestines
Abnormal stool colour, no or infrequent odour	Stomach/Large Intestine-Qi deficiency
URINE	
Frequent, urgent, painful, burning, turbid yellow, foul odour	Damp-Heat in Bladder
Heavy smell of urea, scanty yellow urine	Heart-Fire pouring into Bladder
Clear, frequent, odourless (or slightly fishy)	Kidney deficiency
Odourless urinary incontinence	Exhaustion of Kidney-Fire (Kidney-Yang)
VAGINAL DISCHARGE & LOCHIA	
Strong-smelling, leathery	Damp-Heat
Fishy smell	Damp-Cold
Strong-smelling lochia after childbirth	Damp-Heat or Toxic Heat in the Uterus
ODOURS OF NOSE, EARS, EYES	
Nose — yellow sticky discharge, foul odour	Heat in Lung, or Damp-Heat in Spleen/Stomach
Ears — foul, fishy odour, turbid pus/discharge	Damp-Heat in the ear
Eyes — red/swollen, turbid tears, foul fishy odour or ulcerations	Damp-Heat in the Liver channel
INTESTINAL GAS	
Strong, foul-smelling	Damp-Heat in the Large Intestine
Rancid, rotten (like rotten eggs)	Toxic Heat in the Large Intestines
Release without smell	Spleen-Qi deficiency

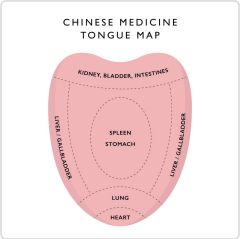
PATTERN NAME	DISEASE CATEGORY	WEEK / QUIZ

ETIOLOGY	ORGAN SYSTEM	DATE

CLINICAL ESSENTIALS — CASE NOTES

HEARING & SMELLING 聞診

CHINESE MEDICINE TONGUE MAP



VOICE / COUGH / ODOURS

PULSE 脈診 · CUN · GUAN · CHI

Wrist	CUN 寸	GUAN 關	CHI 尺
L HT/SI		LV/GB	KD/BL
R LU/LI		SP/ST	PC/TB

QUALITY / OVERALL

TREATMENT PRINCIPLE 治則

KEY POINTS / HERBS

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This image shows a full page of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

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